WEEK 5 · LECTURE L3 · UNIT I

Real Time Feedback Platforms

What monitoring does, how often feedback should come, an Indian recognition architecture, and planned change.

R K Singh · Senior Professor, Department of Commerce · Delhi School of Economics, University of Delhi

DSEH004 · Performance Management and Employee Engagement · M.Com. PGCF 2025 · Exam preparation edition

AFTER THIS LECTURE YOU SHOULD BE ABLE TO

What this lecture prepares you for

- Evaluate the risks of electronic performance monitoring.
- Explain why more frequent feedback is not always better.
- Analyze an employee first management architecture.
- Apply Lewin's model of planned change to a new feedback system.

COURSE OUTCOMES

CLO 1 (design performance management systems) and CLO 4 (analyze feedback and data practices).

COMMIT BEFORE THEORY

More feedback is always better feedback.

Agree or disagree. Where would you expect the limit to be?

THEORY IN DEPTH · RAVID ET AL. (2020)

What electronic monitoring does

THE CORE IDEA

Electronic performance monitoring observes, records and analyzes data related to job performance.

HOW IT WORKS

Its effects on performance and attitudes are contradictory, and depend on how monitoring is designed and used.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

A review and framework; it organizes evidence rather than settling the effect size.

IN PRACTICE

A call center that uses screen monitoring for coaching gets a different response from one that uses it for discipline.

EXAM LENS

Argue that design and purpose decide the effect. Pair with Ball (2010) on control and trust.

SURVEILLANCE · BALL (2010)

Monitoring changes the relationship

THE CLAIM

Monitoring shifts the employment relationship toward control.

THE RISK

It can erode trust, and with it the willingness to give discretionary effort.

THEORY IN DEPTH · LAM ET AL. (2011); KLUGER AND DENISI (1996)

How often is enough?

THE CORE IDEA

Performance improves with feedback frequency up to a point, then declines: an inverted U.

HOW IT WORKS

Very frequent feedback can overload attention and pull focus from the task toward the self.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Laboratory tasks; the best frequency at work varies with the job and the person.

IN PRACTICE

A sales app that pings reps after every call may help new hires and distract experienced ones.

EXAM LENS

Use it against the claim that real time feedback is always better. Design for the right frequency.

AN INDIAN ARCHITECTURE · NAYAR (2010)

Employees first, customers second

THE IDEA

Invert the pyramid: management exists to enable the frontline employees who create value.

THE MECHANISMS

Transparency of information, and open forums in which employees could question leaders.

THE TEST

Does the feedback system serve employees, or only watch them?

PLANNED CHANGE · LEWIN (1947)

Lewin's three steps

UNFREEZE

Create readiness: show why the current state cannot continue

›

CHANGE

Move to new behaviors, with support

›

REFREEZE

Embed the new behaviors in systems and norms

COMPARE AND EVALUATE

Two designs for a feedback platform

	Control design	Development design
Purpose	Detect underperformance	Help people improve
Who sees the data	Managers only	The employee first
Frequency	Continuous	Matched to the task
Likely effect on trust	Falls	Holds or rises

EXAM LENS

Strong answers name purpose, visibility and frequency as the three design choices that decide the outcome.

PRACTICE FOR THE END TERM EXAMINATION

Questions to rehearse

"Real time feedback platforms improve performance." Critically evaluate. **20 marks**

A strong answer: uses Lam et al. and Kluger and DeNisi on frequency; Ravid et al. and Ball on monitoring; proposes a development design.

Use Lewin's model to plan the introduction of a continuous feedback system in an Indian firm. **20 marks**

A strong answer: applies all three steps; addresses resistance and trust; includes measures of success; notes the critique of refreezing in fast change.

Why can very frequent feedback reduce performance? **10 marks**

A strong answer: explains attention and overload; cites the inverted U; one example.

CARRY THESE INTO THE EXAMINATION

Three things to remember

1. Feedback frequency has an optimum, not a maximum
2. Monitoring for control erodes trust; purpose decides the effect
3. New systems need unfreezing before they can be refrozen

SET READINGS · FROM THE LESSON PLAN

Read for this lecture

Kaplan, R. S., & Norton, D. P. (1996). *The balanced scorecard: Translating strategy into action*. Harvard Business School Press. Chapter 1.

Whitmore, J. (2017). *Coaching for performance* (5th ed.). Nicholas Brealey. Chapter on the GROW model.

Cappelli, P., & Tavis, A. (2016). The performance management revolution. *Harvard Business Review, 94*(10), 58–67.

HOW TO USE THESE

These are the Week 5 set readings. Cappelli and Tavis (2016) is the core reading for this lecture.

Sources for this lecture (1 of 2)

Works named on the slides of this lecture. They are background sources, not set readings.

Ball, K. (2010). Workplace surveillance: An overview. *Labor History, 51*(1), 87–106. https://doi.org/10.1080/00236561003654776

Kluger, A. N., & DeNisi, A. (1996). The effects of feedback interventions on performance: A historical review, a meta analysis, and a preliminary feedback intervention theory. *Psychological Bulletin, 119*(2), 254–284. https://doi.org/10.1037/0033-2909.119.2.254

Lam, C. F., DeRue, D. S., Karam, E. P., & Hollenbeck, J. R. (2011). The impact of feedback frequency on learning and task performance: Challenging the “more is better” assumption. *Organizational Behavior and Human Decision Processes, 116*(2), 217–228. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.obhdp.2011.05.002

Sources for this lecture (2 of 2)

Lewin, K. (1947). Frontiers in group dynamics: Concept, method and reality in social science; social equilibria and social change. *Human Relations, 1*(1), 5–41. https://doi.org/10.1177/001872674700100103

Nayar, V. (2010). *Employees first, customers second: Turning conventional management upside down*. Harvard Business Press.

Ravid, D. M., Tomczak, D. L., White, J. C., & Behrend, T. S. (2020). EPM 20/20: A review, framework, and research agenda for electronic performance monitoring. *Journal of Management, 46*(1), 100–126. https://doi.org/10.1177/0149206319869435